The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Pure Light of Stainless Rays

Āryaraśmivimalaviśuddhaprabhānāmadhāraṇī · Toh 982 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་འདོད་ཟེར་དྲི་མེད་པ་རྣམ་པར་དག་པའི་འོད་ཅེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Pure Light of Stainless Rays, known in Sanskrit as the Āryaraśmivimalaviśuddhaprabhā Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as 'Phags pa 'od zer dri ma med pa rnam par dag pa'i 'od ces bya ba'i gzungs, is a dhāraṇī scripture: a discourse built around a sacred incantation believed to carry purifying and protective power. It opens in the traditional way of a sūtra, with the Buddha dwelling in the great courtyard of the palace at Kapilavastu. He is joined by a large assembly of monks and many great bodhisattvas, including Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, Vajrapāṇi, Avalokiteśvara, Mañjuśrī, Prajñāprabha, and Maitreya, along with gods, nāgas, and countless other beings who honor him. This setting frames the teaching and recitation of the dhāraṇī and the benefits said to come from it. The work is Toh 982 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇī texts. Like many such works, it also appears elsewhere in the canon among the tantra texts.

In the language of India: ārya rasmi'i mala biśuddhe prabha nā madhā ra ṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called the Pure Light of Stainless Rays.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling in the great courtyard surrounding the palace in the great city of Kapilavastu, together with a great Saṅgha of monks and a very great many bodhisattva great beings: the bodhisattva great being Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, Vajrapāṇi, the noble Avalokiteśvara, Mañjuśrī, Prajñāprabha, Maitreya, and countless other bodhisattva great beings. Countless gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, nonhumans, and others paid homage to the Blessed One, honored him, and showed him reverence, and he dwelt there teaching the Dharma to those who surrounded him.

At that time there lived in the city of Kapilavastu a great brahmin called Kapilacandra, who had no faith in the teaching of the Blessed One and held wrong views. On a certain occasion someone else appeared to him in a dream and told him, "Great brahmin, seven days from now you will die." When he

heard this, the brahmin was deeply distressed. Terrified, he thought to himself, "Now, to whom shall I turn for protection for my life? It is said that the ascetic Gautama is omniscient and possesses miraculous powers. I will go to him. If he truly is omniscient, he will surely teach the Dharma in order to protect one stricken with this fear."

With this in mind he went to the Blessed One. Seeing from far away the Blessed One seated together with a great retinue, he did not dare to ask him, and he stayed there, brooding. But the Blessed One, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha, who knows the three times and sees all things without obstruction, knew the brahmin's thoughts. Regarding him with tenderness and a mind of loving-kindness, he said:

"Great brahmin, seven days from now you will die and be reborn in the lower realms, the evil destinies, in the hell of Avīci. After that you will be reborn in succession in the sixteen great hells. Even when you are freed from them, you will be reborn in the body of a butcher, of low caste. Then, when you die and pass on, you will be reborn in the body of a pig, always eating vomit and filth, and you will live for a long time in the mud and mire, continually experiencing suffering. After that, even if you gain a human body, you will be extremely poor, filthy, foul-smelling, ugly and dark in complexion, emaciated and feeble, and afflicted with leprosy. You will be unpleasant to all people, always tormented by hunger, reviled and scorned by everyone, beaten and abused, and you will suffer greatly."

When he heard these words, the brahmin was utterly terrified. Weeping with anguish, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and said, "Blessed One, since the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas are the protectors and refuge of all sentient beings, I confess all my evil deeds. If from this day forward I act according to the word of the Blessed One, please protect me from the suffering of rebirth in the lower realms, the evil destinies, the hells."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One said, "Great brahmin, go to the crossroads on the road of the city of Kapilavastu. There stands an old, ruined stupa containing relics. Rebuild it, set up a central pole at the top of the stupa, write out the secret mantra and place it inside. Then make offerings and recite the secret mantra seven times on each occasion. Your life will then be extended and will increase. When you die, you will be reborn in the happy destinies, in the higher realms, in states of great wealth, and for a hundred thousand eons your enjoyment of happiness will increase and expand. After

that you will be reborn in the completely pure buddha field of the Tathāgata Akṣobhya, where you will experience great bliss for many hundreds of thousands of eons. Then, when you die and pass on from there, you will be reborn in the abode of the gods of the Four Great Kings, and there too, for a hundred thousand great eons, you will experience inexhaustible enjoyment of happiness. In every life, wherever you are born, your mind will be clear and your life will be without untimely interruption. All your karmic obscurations will be exhausted, and you will never fall into the hells. You will always meet the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas who appear, and they will keep you in their care.

"Furthermore, great brahmin, if there is any monk, nun, layman, laywoman, son of good family or daughter of good family whose life is short or who suffers from many illnesses, let that person either repair an old stupa or build a new one, write out this secret mantra and place it inside, clean the maṇḍala, and make offerings. The benefits for them will be these: even one whose life is exhausted will have it extended and lengthened; even one afflicted and suffering from illness will be freed from every disease; and they will never be reborn in the lower realms, the evil destinies, the hells, the animal realm, or the world of Yama. They will not even hear the sound of those names, so what need is there to speak of being born there?"

Then the brahmin, having heard these words, rejoiced greatly. Resolving to repair the ruined stupa, he rose from that assembly and departed.

At that time, in that very assembly, the bodhisattva great being called Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin rose from his seat, joined his palms, and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, how should this rite of the secret mantra be performed so that it gives rise to good qualities, to excellence, and to roots of virtue?"

When he had asked this, the Blessed One said: "This supreme among great secret mantras, the magnanimous one called Stainless and Utterly Pure Light, should be performed according to the rite of the great maṇḍala. Then, through the blessing of all the tathāgatas, it will bring benefit and happiness to all sentient beings. If anyone hears this secret mantra, even the evil of having committed the five deeds of immediate retribution will be purified without remainder. All roots of non-virtue, such as avarice, covetousness and envy, will also be purified. Even when one's life has run out, it will be extended to a long life, and all good fortune, excellence and abundance will be accomplished."

When he had said this, the bodhisattva great being Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin again addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, so that the Blessed One may be a refuge for the lives of all sentient beings and may clear away all karmic obscurations, please, Blessed One, teach this rite of the secret mantra to the whole assembly gathered here."

When he had made this request, the Blessed One consented. From the top of the crown protuberance on the Blessed One's head there came forth a great radiance of light rays, which filled the whole great trichiliocosm, the world system of a billion worlds, with light, and made it known to all the tathāgatas as well. Then those light rays gathered back and dissolved into the crown protuberance on the Blessed One's head.

Then the Blessed One, delighted, spoke the secret mantra in a voice like the song of the kalaviṅka bird:

namaḥ sabtānāna saṃmyaksaṃbuddha koṭīnāna pariśuddhe manasi abhyārcita bratiṣṭhitānāna namo bhagabate amṛta āyuṣasya tathāgatasya oṃ sarba tathāgata śuddhe āyura biśodhani saṃhara saṃhara sarba tathāgata bīrya balen pratisaṃhara āyuḥ sāra sāra sarba tathāgata samaya bodhi bodhi buddhya buddhya bodhaya bodhaya mama sarba pāba āvaraṇa biśuddhe bigata malaṃ charsu buddhe buddhe huru huru svāhā

"This is the root mantra. Whoever wishes to perform its rite should, on any one of the eighth, thirteenth, fourteenth or fifteenth days of the month, circumambulate a stupa containing relics seventy-seven times and recite this secret mantra seventy-seven times. Then, having bathed and made a maṇḍala, one should write out seventy-seven copies of the secret mantra. At that time, both when reciting the secret mantra and when writing it out, one should bathe, put on clean clothes, anoint the body with fragrances, eat clean food, and make offerings of flowers and incense. One should also present the seven kinds of precious things as a fee for this, or else offer whatever one can afford according to one's means, so as to bring satisfaction. In order to honor the Dharma, one should show great reverence and respect. Regarding the written copies of the secret mantra as rare and precious, one should build seventy-seven stupas, large or small, as many as one is able, and place the secret mantra inside each one. If one then makes great offerings with a one-pointed mind, one's life, even when it has run out, will be extended again and become long. All the karmic obscurations of the past, the evils of countless lifetimes, will be purified, and one will never be reborn in any of the

births of hell-beings, animals or hungry ghosts. In every place where one is born, one will remember one's former lives. Everything one has in mind will likewise be accomplished. One will generate roots of virtue in the presence of as many as seventy-seven hundred thousand tathāgatas. One will be freed from all illness and suffering.

"If anyone is struck by a grave illness and is on the point of death, one should make a square maṇḍala and draw designs on it in five colors. In the center one should draw a wheel, a vajra, a conch, a trident, a svastika design, and lotuses. In each of the four corners one should also draw a lotus, and on top of each one should place a vase filled with scented water, one in each of the four corners. One should also set out a vessel filled with incense, sprinkled with various fragrances. In vessels of five colors one should set out various foods, the three white foods, and rice prepared as cooked rice. Further, one should set out scented water, flowers, and vessels filled with rice or grain, each poured into its own bowl. Further, one should place on the maṇḍala a torma made of various foods, together with a vase full of scented water. Close by that torma and the rice one should draw an image of Gaṇapati, and on the top of its head place a lamp. Then one should seat the sick person on the western side of the maṇḍala, and in front of the sick person, who faces into the maṇḍala, one should also set out food offerings and have the sick person present them. Then the mantra practitioner, being scrupulously clean, should apply the secret mantra to the sick person seventy-seven times. If the rite is performed in this way, then even a sick person whose life has run out and who is close to death, who for seven days has lost mindfulness and become confused, will have their life extended again and become long-lived. Nor will they experience the suffering of bad dreams.

"If anyone, being scrupulously clean, recites the secret mantra once each day, constantly, for as long as they live, then when they die they will be born in a place of inexhaustible wealth and happiness. If one recites it constantly, at all times, one will be born in a field where a buddha dwells, and will also remember one's former lives. Untimely death and all obscurations will also be purified.

"Further, if anyone, wishing to benefit someone who has died, recites the secret mantra seventy-seven times from the depths of the heart, then even if the dead person has fallen into the lower realms, at that very moment their karmic obscurations will be exhausted, and they will be born among the gods in the higher realms and experience happiness. Further, if anyone writes out

the secret mantra, mentioning another person by name, places it inside a stupa and earnestly makes offerings, then whoever has died will be freed from the lower realms and born in the higher realms. Or else they will be born among the gods of Tuṣita, and through the blessing of the Buddha they will not fall into the lower realms."

Any son or daughter of good family who circumambulates that stupa, prostrates to it, or presents offerings to it will, through the blessing of the Tathāgata, become irreversible on the path to unsurpassed awakening. Their obscurations of past karma will also be completely purified. Even birds, wild animals and the like, whoever the shadow of that stupa falls upon, will never be born in the lower realms, as animals or otherwise. Even someone burdened with the great evil of the five deeds of immediate retribution, if they touch that stupa or its shadow falls on them, will have all their evil purified and exhausted.

In the place where that stupa stands, none of the bhūtas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, pretas, piśācas and the like, who enter the body and do harm, nor fierce beasts of prey, nor falling lightning, nor venomous snakes, nor prepared poisons and the like, will be able to cause harm, and they will cease to be. Furthermore, hostile armies, weapons, fire, water, hail, famine, untimely death, bad dreams, ill omens, and all the harms of suffering will cease to be.

Even if an evil portent appears in that land, a great light will arise through the blessing of the stupa and of the Buddha, and all evil portents and ill omens will be averted. And if someone else, with evil intent, plans to do harm with armies or bandits, or if an attacking enemy appears, a great light will arise from that stupa in that place. Through the miraculous power of the Tathāgata, from within an encircling blaze of flames, troops and a rain of weapons will be displayed, and so all the hostile armies will be pacified and turned back. The gods too will guard and protect it, sealing off a boundary of up to a hundred yojanas in the four directions, and because they guard it, no unrest, contagious disease, or livestock disease will arise within it. Fighting and quarrels will not arise. Conduct contrary to the Dharma will cease. Other secret mantras cannot cut off or suppress this, because it is the root of all secret mantras.

Next, the secret mantra of the life-pole of that stupa is explained:

oṃ sarva tathāgata vibula yaṣṭi maṇi kanaka rājata vibuṣita yaṣṭi dhuru dhuru samanhe vilokite sara sara mama sarva pāba viśodhani sam bodhani prabara

yaṣṭi pari maṇi duṣṭa huru cira mala viśuddhe hūṃ hūṃ svāhā

Son of good family, by all means this secret mantra should be carefully written out ninety-nine times and placed on the four sides of the stupa's life-pole. Moreover, this ritual text itself should also be written out and placed inside the life-pole. If the rite is done in this way, it is like erecting the life-poles of ninety-nine thousand stupas. Beyond that, it is like building ninety-nine thousand stupas containing relics. Beyond even that, it will be as though one had made ninety-nine thousand stupas of the seven precious substances. Beyond even that, it is like constructing, for the sake of making offerings to the Tathāgata, ninety-nine thousand temple stupas like Sudharmā, the assembly hall of the gods.

Again, if anyone makes a small stupa out of clay and places these secret mantras inside it, it is like building ninety-nine thousand stupas of the seven precious substances. Again, if anyone circumambulates this stupa, prostrates to it, joins their palms to it, offers flowers, offers ointments and incense, or offers even a few bells, banners or parasols, that equals the merit of making offerings to the stupas of ninety-nine thousand tathāgatas. They will attain the glory of the complete fulfillment of all roots of virtue, and vast power and strength. Even if the shadow of that stupa falls on birds, bees and the like, the Tathāgata knows them and keeps them in mind, and they will attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening and will abide on the irreversible ground.

Again, whoever dreams of such a stupa in a dream, sees it from afar, hears the sound of its bells, or hears talk of a stupa being erected, all their evil deeds and obscurations, the five deeds of immediate retribution and the rest, will be purified. The tathāgatas will always protect them and keep them in mind, and they will attain the completely pure path of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. This secret mantra is called the secret mantra of the stupa's life-pole.

Again, son of good family, the heart of those secret mantras for making a stupa of the Tathāgata is this:

oṃ sarva tathāgata mala viśodhani ruddha bale prati saṃskār tathāgata dhātu dhare dhara dhara sandhara sandhara sarva tathāgata adhiṣṭāna adhiṣṭhite svāhā

Whether a monk, nun, layman or laywoman, or anyone at all, makes a stupa oneself, has another make one, or properly restores an old stupa, whether one

makes a small stupa of earth and clay, or makes it of brick or stone, one should first recite the heart mantra a full one thousand and eight times. After that, whether one makes the stupa on a patch of ground the size of a fingernail, or makes it a cubit in size, or even makes it about a yojana in size, through the power of the secret mantra and the strength of one-pointed concentration of mind, a fragrance of incense will rise from that stupa, the scent of sandalwood, camphor, musk, saffron and the like, or the delightful fragrance of divine incense will arise. For oneself and others who perform the work of the stupa and do the recitation, all their aspirations will be fulfilled just as they wish.

They will accumulate vast roots of virtue, and they will also attain qualities and goodness in abundance. Even if they have karma for a short life, their life will be lengthened and made long. When the time of death comes, they will see the faces of ninety-nine hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of buddhas. Those tathāgatas will hold them in mind, and in their next birth they will be born in a completely pure buddha field and will receive a prophecy in person. There, too, they will live for a hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of years. They will attain the recollection of former lives, the divine eye, and the pure divine ear, and they will attain the knowledge of others' minds and the knowledge of passing away and being born. The scent of sandalwood will come from their bodies, and the fragrance of the blue lotus will rise from their mouths. Having attained the path of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, they will also attain the stage of irreversibility.

Further, if one recites the secret mantra over scented ointment, even an amount the size of a mustard seed, and anoints a stupa with it, one will also obtain those qualities and that goodness just as explained before.

Further, any monk, nun, layman, or laywoman who has made himself or herself clean and takes up these words of secret mantra, regarding them as rare and precious, should have faith in them as in a Tathāgata. Having generated respect for the secret mantras, they should write them down. Having written the secret mantras and mudrās according to the rite as explained above, they should place the essence at the base of the central pole of the stupa. If they build a stupa in this way, they will accumulate vast roots of virtue and will attain all qualities and goodness.

Then, when the Blessed One had taught these rites of the mudrās of secret mantra, all the tathāgatas dwelling in the world systems of the ten directions

rejoiced and said, "That the perfectly complete Buddha Śākyamuni, regarding all sentient beings equally and establishing them all in the dharmadhātu, has taught how to obtain the blessing of the rite of the mudrās of the great secret mantra is excellent, excellent! It is excellent indeed! Through those roots of virtue they will attain unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening and will also become irreversible."

Then, in that very circle of the assembly, the gathered gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, gandharvas, asuras, kinnaras, and great mahoragas, the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi, the Four Great Kings, Brahmā, grandfather and protector of the world, Viṣṇu, Maheśvara, Śakra, Yama, Varuṇa, Kubera, and the other gods of great miraculous power, having heard what the Blessed One had said, grew weary of and disenchanted with their own respective spheres. Wishing gradually to attain great qualities, they called out to one another and said, "Oh! The appearance of a perfectly complete buddha is extremely hard to find. To hear the sacred Dharma, his teaching, is also extremely hard to find. To hear the collection of secret mantras and mudrās taught by a perfectly complete buddha is also extremely hard to find. This is most wondrous!"

Then, at that time, the brahmin called Kapilacandra, having heard and received from the Blessed One such great qualities of secret mantra and rite, had the dust and turbidity of the obscurations of his mind become clear. His fear of death, his misdeeds, and all his karmic obscurations were purified as well. His life too was lengthened and made long, and he was delighted, pleased, and joyful, and attained great happiness. Then all the hosts of bhūtas also became faithful in mind and rejoiced.

Then the bodhisattva mahāsattva Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, in order to make an offering to the Tathāgata, emanated in that assembly a jeweled mansion of many stories adorned with various gems. Out of delight in the Dharma he offered it to the Blessed One, circumambulated him three times, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, and said to the Blessed One, "The Blessed One has taught, for the sake of the beings of Jambudvīpa who have great obscurations, rites of secret mantra, mudrā, and maṇḍala that are extremely hard to find, supreme among all that brings benefit and happiness to sentient beings, which generate roots of virtue, give long life, and free one from all the masses of suffering. That being so, we bodhisattvas here also, having made our request to all the buddhas, the blessed ones, wish to speak, in the presence of the Tathāgata, the mudrā and the words of secret mantra that bring genuine wisdom to completion:

namo bhagavate navanavatīnāṃ saṃmyaksaṃbuddha koṭi niyuta śata sahasrāṇāṃ namaḥ sarva nivāraṇ viskamvini bodhisatvāya oṃ turu turu mama sarva āvaraṇa viśodhani sarva tathāgata āyurbalāni vipula nirmale sarva siddhi namskṛtvā varavar sarva satvā avalokini oṃ sarva nivāraṇa viskamviṇi mama sarva pāva viśodhani kuru svāhā

"Blessed One, this secret mantra of mine has been taught by ninety-nine koṭis of buddhas. If anyone, with an undistracted mind, one-pointedly recites it even for a single instant, all their misdeeds will be purified. Further, if anyone writes this secret mantra ninety-nine times according to the rite and places it inside a stupa, then if anyone prostrates to that stupa, praises it with sweet words, or offers incense, flowers, ointment, and lamps, that child of good family will, in this very life, have all misdeeds purified and all karmic obscurations removed, and all their wishes will be fulfilled as desired. It will be equal to having made offerings and rendered service to countless hundreds of thousands of buddhas, blessed ones, as many as the sands of the river Ganges. Likewise, it will be as though they had made offerings to hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of stupas containing relics, as many as the sands of the river Ganges.

…his vast roots of virtue will be accumulated.

Moreover, a renunciant (śramaṇa) might, on any of the eighth, the fourteenth or the fifteenth day of the month, bathe and make himself clean, put on clean clothes, and keep a fast for a single day, or else eat the three white foods. If he then circumambulates a stupa and recites this secret mantra one hundred and eight times, all the obscurations of karma accumulated over a hundred thousand eons, and even the commission of the five acts of immediate retribution, will be completely purged. Furthermore, all his obscurations of karma and affliction will be purified. The bodhisattva Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin will reveal his own body to him and grant all his wishes as accomplishments, and he will also see the faces of all the perfectly complete buddhas.

In the same way, whoever recites it two hundred and eight times will attain meditative absorption. Whoever recites it three hundred and eight times will be cleansed of all obscurations and will abide on the irreversible ground. Whoever recites it four hundred and eight times, even the great kings, the Four Great Kings, will approach and reveal their bodies to him. They will guard him and be his refuge, will also give rise to the power of wisdom in him, and will bring about all merit. Whoever recites it five hundred and eight times will, by that very root of virtue, attain abiding on the unconditioned path. Whoever

recites it six hundred and eight times will become a holder of vidyā-mantras and will go to the abode of the vidyādharas in the sky. Whoever recites it a full seven hundred and eight times will be endowed with all excellent qualities. Whoever recites it eight hundred and eight times will gain independence, commanded by no one else, and his mind will be purified. Whoever recites it nine hundred and eight times will have the five aggregates purified. Whoever recites it one thousand and eight times will attain the fruit of stream-entry. Whoever recites it a full two thousand times will attain the fruit of once-returning. Whoever recites it a full three thousand times will attain the fruit of non-returning. Whoever recites it a full four thousand times will attain the fruit of an arhat. Whoever recites it a full five thousand times will attain the state of a pratyekabuddha. Whoever recites it a full six thousand times will attain the station of the miraculous powers of a bodhisattva. Whoever recites it a full seven thousand times will attain the first ground of a bodhisattva. Whoever recites it a full eight thousand times will set foot on the fifth bodhisattva ground. Whoever recites it a full nine thousand times will attain the body of the Lord of Secrets, master of the vidyā-mantras and secret mantras. Whoever recites it a full ten thousand times will set foot on the eighth bodhisattva ground, the Immovable. Whoever recites it a full twenty thousand times will attain the body of an unsurpassed, perfectly complete buddha and will roar the great lion's roar.

Again, if anyone wishes to perform a meritorious deed for the sake of his father and mother, let him restore an old stupa containing relics that has fallen into ruin, and repair it well. If he circumambulates it, keeping it to his right, and goes on circumambulating until he has completed a full one hundred and eight recitations of the mantra, all his wishes will be fulfilled just as he desires.

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the bodhisattva Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, saying, "Excellent! Excellent, excellent, son of noble family! You have been my helper. What you have properly explained of the rite of the Tathāgata's secret mantra is exactly so."

Then the Lord of Secrets, king of all the yakṣas, said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, since the Blessed One's king of secret mantras and these rites of secret mantra are like the tathāgatas, and have arisen from the Dharma body of the tathāgatas, Blessed One, these supreme essences will clear away the obscurations of karma and all the misdeeds of the beings dwelling in Jambudvīpa, and from then on they will enter the Blessed One's teaching."

When he had said this, the Blessed One said to the Lord of Secrets, "Lord of Secrets, even in times to come these rites of secret mantra will be like the Tathāgata dwelling in the world. If one does the rite just as I have taught it, then even a small ritual effort will accomplish a great result and abide as a great benefit. What need is there to mention performing the ritual on a large scale? All roots of virtue will be accumulated. Therefore, even if hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of tathāgatas, as many as the sands of the river Ganges, were to describe their qualities, they could not finish; only those tathāgatas know and see them."

The Lord of Secrets said, "Blessed One, by doing what small undertaking will a great fruit of merit be accomplished and great merit obtained?"

The Blessed One said, "Then listen well, and I shall explain. Any monk, nun, layman or laywoman who wishes to obtain a great fruit of merit and to obtain good qualities should perform the rite of the king of secret mantras as taught before. Writing it out in ninety-nine copies, he should make a square maṇḍala in front of a stupa of the Buddha and smear it with cow dung. At each of the four corners he should set a bowl filled with scented water, and also set out a censer giving off smoke. Into a large vessel he should put flowers, scented water and dry rice, and place it on the maṇḍala. Also, mixing black sesame, māṣa beans and rice, he should put the cooked rice porridge called kṛsara and the three white foods into a vase. Then he should spread out on the maṇḍala ninety-nine assorted fruits, these foods just named, incense, flowers and so forth. Having placed the letters of the secret mantra inside the central life-pole of the stupa, he should visualize vividly, on the four sides of the stupa, all the tathāgatas of the ten directions, prostrate to them, and recite these secret mantras with a one-pointed mind.

It is as follows: oṃ bipula bimale prabarjin bare sara sara sarba tathāgata dhātu garbhe adhiṣṭhite svāhā āyatatobaṇi svāhā sarba debaṇi bahaya bibuddha adhiṣṣāna samaye svāhā

One should keep incense burning without interruption. If one recites the mantra twenty-eight times, then the eight great bodhisattva mahāsattvas, the eight great yakṣa generals, the Lord of Secrets, the Four Great Kings, Brahmā, Maheśvara, and Nārāyaṇa will at that very moment make offerings to that stūpa and honor it, and make its central life-pole firm. Beyond that, ninety-nine hundred thousand koṭis of buddhas, as many even as the sands of the river Ganges, will come to that place, make offerings to that stūpa, bless it

as the Dharma body, and make it possess relics.

If one performs the rite properly in this way, from the depths of one's heart, one will obtain those qualities, and furthermore one will obtain the merit of having made that stūpa out of precious wish-fulfilling jewels. It will be like having made stūpas from many hundred thousand niyutas of koṭis of kinds of precious things. One will possess vast roots of virtue, one's body will be completely pure, one will be long-lived and free of illness, and no obstructors whatsoever will be able to harm one.

Furthermore, whoever sees this stūpa, or even hears the sound of that stūpa's bells, will have all obscurations of karma and all misdeeds purified. Even one who has committed the five deeds of immediate retribution will be completely purified, and after dying will be born in the world of Sukhāvatī. Whoever merely hears the name of that stūpa will, after dying, attain the path of unsurpassed awakening. Even any being, such as a bird or a wild animal, that sees it will, on passing from that life, leave behind birth as an animal and obtain a body endowed with merit.

Whoever wishes to practice the six perfections to completion should, as before, make a square maṇḍala and smear it with earth and cow dung, and on top of that smear it with fragrant unguent. At each of the four corners of the maṇḍala one should place a vessel filled with scented water. Of the four mantras taught earlier, one should write out each single one ninety-nine times. With one's own hand one should mold ninety-nine small stūpas, and insert one of the mantras into each. Then one should also write out this mantra ninety-nine times, insert it into the spire rings of the stūpas, and place the stūpas on top of the maṇḍala. One should make offerings of flowers and unguents, circumambulate seven times each, and also recite this mantra:

namaḥ npanpatīnāṃ tathāgata gaṃgā nātībālukānāṃ koṭi niyuta śata sahasrāṇāṃ yoṃ pobori cariṇi cari mori kori calabāri svāhā

If one performs the rite in this way, not only will one have practiced the six perfections to completion, but one will thereby have made precious stūpas numbering hundreds of thousands of niyutas of koṭis, as many as the sands of the river Ganges. One will have made offerings to, attended on, and honored as many as ninety-nine hundred thousand niyutas of koṭis of perfectly complete buddhas. Beyond that, all the gods will gather various clouds of offerings, furnish that stūpa with various articles, and make offerings, furnishing it as a palace of the Tathāgata with various articles. That many

perfectly complete buddhas will know it, see it, and bless it. They will cause that son of noble family or daughter of noble family to obtain the merit of vast roots of virtue and all good qualities.

Again, whoever writes out this king of mantras with its essence free of error, recites it constantly, performs the acts of offering, and wears it on the body will be protected and sheltered by that very spell. All hostile enemies, all rivals, yakṣas, rākṣasas, hungry ghosts and the rest will be unable to do harm; terrified and afraid, they will scatter in every direction. Whoever even converses with one who recites the spell will have even the karmic obscurations of the five deeds of immediate retribution completely purified. Whoever hears the voice of that mantra practitioner, or is touched by his shadow, or even touches his body, will have all karmic obscurations and misdeeds of other lifetimes completely purified.

The body of one who recites the spell cannot be harmed by poison, will not be burned by fire, and will not be carried away by water. No graha whatsoever will find an opening, and lightning will not strike him. All the buddhas will protect and shelter him and sustain him with their gaze. All the gods and all those bound by sacred commitment will also be his companions and helpers, and he cannot be harmed by any spells, curses, or magical applications of others.

Therefore, wherever the reciter of the spell may dwell, he should seek out the rite of this mantra. If one writes out the mantra, builds a stūpa at a crossroads of four ways or a junction of three, a place where many people come and go, and inserts it inside, then all beings, birds, bees, and even ants and beetles who see it, hear it, or touch it, or are touched by the earth, dust, wind, or shadow that has touched it, will be freed from all the misdeeds that would cause them to be born as animals, as hungry ghosts, to fall wrongly into the lower realms, or to be born as beings in hell. After dying they will be born in the happy destinies, the higher realms, among the gods. Because their former karmic obscurations have been completely purified, they will attain recollection of their past lives and will become of a nature that does not fall back.

Then the Blessed One addressed the bodhisattva great being Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, Vajrapāṇi the Lord of Secrets, the Four Great Kings, Brahmā the Lord of the Sahā world, the gods of Brahmā's realm, and the gods such as Maheśvara (Śiva): "Holy beings, I entrust these essences of the king of

secret mantras to you. Always honor them and uphold them. Place them inside a jeweled casket, proclaim them in every place, and teach them to beings without ever letting their continuity be broken. When they are seen and heard, even the evil of the five acts of immediate retribution will be purified."

Then the bodhisattva great being Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, Vajrapāṇi the Lord of Secrets, the Four Great Kings, Brahmā, Maheśvara, Nārāyaṇa, and all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, asuras, mahoragas, and the rest bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and spoke with one voice, saying: "Blessed One, the Blessed One has looked upon us with loving care. For the benefit of all beings, all of us shall guard and honor the rite of this secret mantra and the rite of making stūpas, just as they have been taught. We shall always retain them and never forget them. We shall also carry out the work of writing them down, reciting them, and making offerings. The Blessed One has said that in the future, whatever beings hear this Dharma discourse and understand it will be freed from the lower realms and evil destinies, from the hells and the rest, and from all evil. Therefore, in order to receive the Blessed One's kindness upon the crowns of our heads, we shall honor these rites of secret mantra. We shall revere them. We shall respect them. We shall regard them as precious. We shall spread them far and wide. We shall look upon them as we would the face of the Blessed One. We will strive so that they never decline and so that, by every means, they flourish."

When they had said this, the Blessed One said: "Holy beings, that you, abiding by your sacred commitment, have pledged to guard, honor, and uphold these rites of secret mantra is excellent, excellent, truly excellent."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, that entire assembly rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the noble dhāraṇī called The Pure Light of Stainless Rays.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Vidyākarasiṃha and the chief editor-translator Bandé Palgyi Lhünpo Dé. Lord Atiśa and Geshé Dromtönpa corrected the translation of the mantras.

Translator's Notes

• The brahmin's name is rendered from the Tibetan "Moon of Kapila" as Kapilacandra, and "Wisdom Light" among the bodhisattvas as Prajñāprabha. Both are reconstructions from the Tibetan, not Sanskrit forms attested in this text. The rebirths are listed in the order the Tibetan gives them, with Akṣobhya's pure field before the heaven of the Four Great Kings. "Seven times on each occasion" renders the doubled numeral "seven seven."

• "Five deeds of immediate retribution" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□ (pañcānantarya). "Show great reverence and respect" renders the paired terms □□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□, here taken in their sense of honor and esteem. "Apply the secret mantra to the sick person" renders □□□□□□□□□...□□□□□□□□□□□□, meaning to recite the mantra over the patient. It is not an empowerment (□□□).
• The life-pole is the central wooden axis of a stupa, into which mantras and texts are inserted. "Sudharmā" renders □□□□□□□□, the assembly hall of the gods of the Thirty-Three.
• In the gods' disenchantment, the Tibetan shifts briefly into the first person ("our own respective spheres"). This has been rendered in the third person for clarity. The "essence" placed at the base of the stupa's central pole refers to the written dhāraṇī (the heart or essence mantra) deposited as the stupa's core. The sentence "should have faith in them as in a Tathāgata" (de de bzhin gshegs pa dang 'dra bar dad par bya) could also be read as saying that the person who holds the mantra should be regarded with faith like a Tathāgata.
• "Will be completely purged" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "will completely come forth". The context requires the sense of being cleared away, and it may be a slip for □□□□□□□□□□□□□, "completely purified". "Ninety-nine copies" interprets "writing ninety-nine letters/writings" as copies of the mantra, consistent with the ritual of placing mantra texts in the stupa.
• The term rendered "spire rings" is understood as the rings or discs of the stūpa's spire. The term rendered "rivals" is uncertain in sense; it appears to denote adversaries seeking to do harm. The large number rendered "niyuta" is taken as matching the koṭi niyuta śata sahasra sequence in the mantra itself.
• The Indian preceptor's name is written in the Tibetan as Vidyākarasidha. It is rendered here as Vidyākarasiṃha, the form this translator's name usually takes in Kangyur colophons.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.